Dripless

UI/UX Case Study

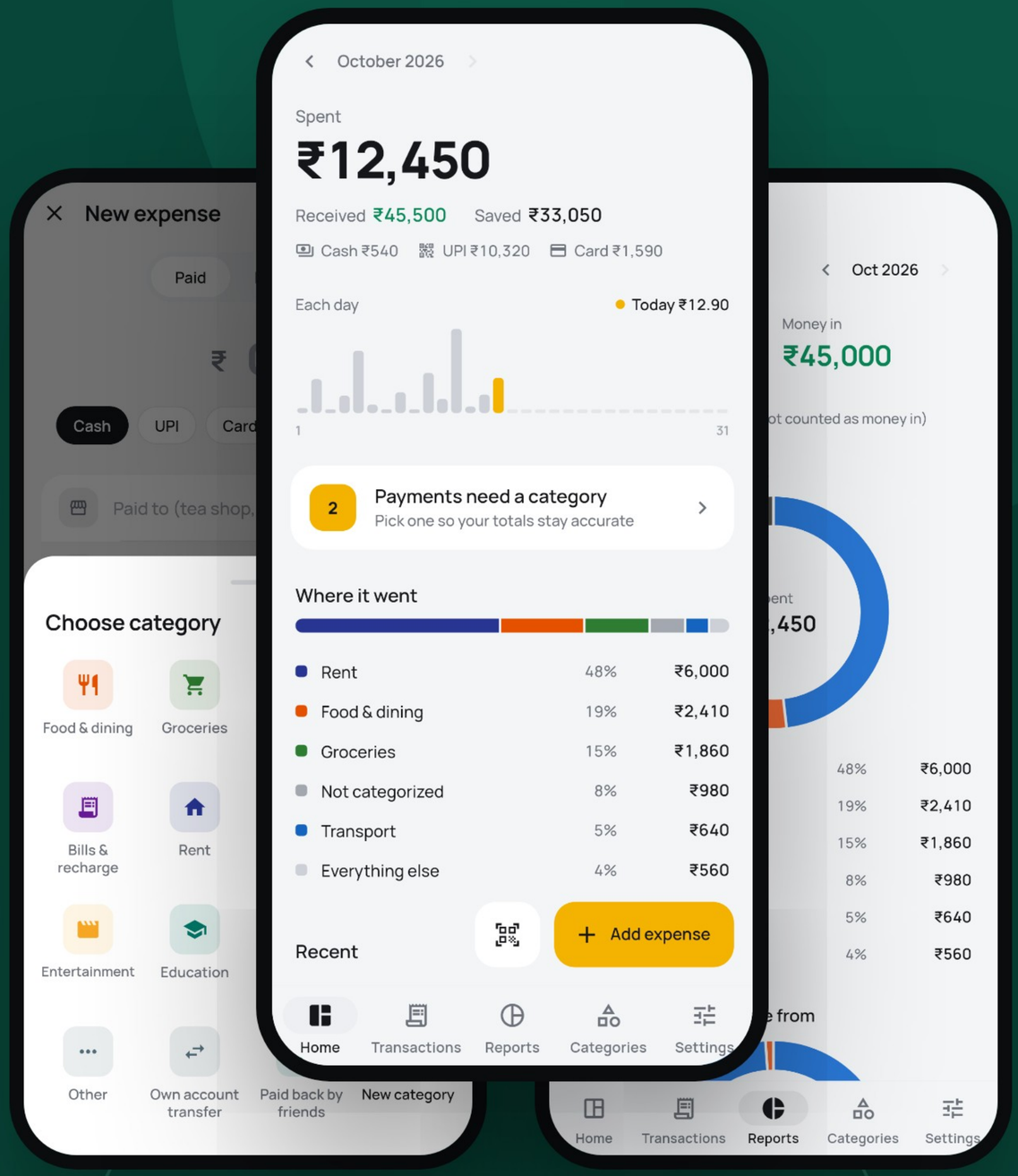
Android app · 2026

PERSONAL FINANCE FOR UPI INDIA

Expense tracking that writes itself.

Dripless reads bank SMS and UPI notifications, records every rupee in and out, and asks one question: what was it for? Everything stays encrypted on the phone.

ROLE	PLATFORM	TOOLS	TIMELINE
UI/UX design	Android	Figma, Flutter	October 2026



Promo film

28 seconds · the whole app in six moments



Dripless

Expense tracking that **writes itself.**

Plays here in Adobe Acrobat. Anywhere else: **Download the video from GitHub**

01

Overview

Most of my spending happens in GPay and PhonePe, a few taps at a time. The money is easy to send and impossible to keep track of. Dripless turns those taps into a clear monthly picture without asking me to type anything.

The challenge

UPI payments are small, frequent and spread across several apps and bank messages. Expense apps that rely on typing every entry get abandoned within days, and cloud finance apps ask for trust many people won't give.

The solution

An Android app that captures payments automatically from SMS and UPI notifications, then asks for a category in one tap from a notification. Reports, splits and Scan & Pay build on that single habit.

My role

End-to-end product design: problem framing, flows, information architecture, visual system, every screen and its states, plus testing each build on a real phone and feeding fixes back.

Automatic recording · One-tap categories · Reports · Split bills · Scan & Pay · Encrypted backup

02

Features

Nine features, one habit: payments come in on their own, you add the meaning. Everything else is there to make that answer more useful.

Automatic recording

Reads bank SMS and Google Pay, PhonePe and Paytm notifications. Money in and money out, with duplicates merged.

Category pop-up

Right after a payment, a notification asks what it was for. One tap and it's filed.

Remembered payees

File a shop once and its next payment arrives already suggested. Rules can be reviewed in Settings.

Add by hand

For cash and card: amount first, then mode, category, date and note.

Split bills

Count only your share. When friends pay back, it's tracked as "Paid back by friends", not income.

Reports

Month or year. Spending and income pies, monthly bars and the places you pay most.

Scan & Pay

Scan a UPI QR in the app, pick the category, pay in your UPI app. Recorded before you're back.

Your own categories

Create one with just a name mid-flow; set its icon and colour later, or hide ones you never use.

Private backup

Encrypted on the phone. Password-locked backup files and a CSV export for spreadsheets.

03

The problem

Four reasons people stop tracking money, and the design response to each. Every feature in Dripless traces back to one of these.

01 Typing every payment doesn't last

A ₹20 chai isn't worth opening an app for. A few missed entries and the totals stop being true.

→ **Record automatically from SMS and notifications**

02 Money is scattered across apps

GPay, PhonePe, card and bank messages each hold part of the story, and none shows in and out together.

→ **One timeline for every source, duplicates merged**

03 Shared bills distort the numbers

Paying ₹2,000 for a group dinner isn't ₹2,000 of my spending, and a friend paying back isn't income.

→ **Splits count your share; paybacks get their own category**

04 Bank data feels too private to upload

Reading SMS is powerful and scary. People want the convenience without their messages leaving the phone.

→ **Encrypted on the phone; OTPs never stored**

PROTO-PERSONA

K **Karthik, 26**

Software engineer · Chennai

"I know my salary comes in. I just never know where it went by the 20th."

GOALS

- See monthly spending by category without effort
- Know what friends still owe after trips and dinners
- Pay by QR and have it filed already

FRUSTRATIONS

- Forgets to log small UPI payments
- Won't give a cloud app access to bank messages
- Group expenses make totals look wrong

04

User flows

Two journeys end in the same place: a payment with a category, counted in the right month. Choosing the category is the only step that needs you.

FLOW A · AUTOMATIC RECORDING

STEP 1
Pay in any UPI app or by card

→

STEP 2
Bank SMS or UPI notification arrives

→

STEP 3
Dripless reads it and merges duplicates

→

YOUR ONE TAP
Pop-up asks for a category

→

DONE
Home and Reports update

FLOW B · SCAN & PAY

STEP 1
Tap scan beside Add expense

→

STEP 2
Scan the UPI QR in the app

→

YOUR ONE TAP
Amount and category

→

STEP 4
UPI PIN in Google Pay or PhonePe

→

DONE
Saved; bank SMS confirms

Information architecture

Five tabs, each with one job

Home
This month at a glance

- Month summary
- Daily bars
- Needs a category
- Where it went
- Recent

Transactions
Every payment, searchable

- Search
- In / out filters
- Add expense
- Edit payment
- Split

Reports
Where money went

- Month / Year
- Out vs in
- Spending pie
- Income pie
- Top places

Categories
Make it yours

- Expense
- Income
- New category
- Icon & colour
- Hide

Settings
Recording and data

- Auto recording
- Scan & Pay
- Payees
- Backup
- Export CSV

05

Style guide

Quiet neutrals so the numbers lead. One accent, marigold, is kept for the things you act on. Green only ever means money coming in.

COLOUR

Ink
#15171A · text, Pay

Marigold
#F5B301 · actions

Money in
#0B8A5A · income

Canvas
#F4F5F7

Raised
#FFFFFF

Line
#E4E6EA

Muted
#6E737C

Attention
#8A5A00

TYPOGRAPHY · MANROPE

₹12,450 — Amount · 800

Where it went — Title · 28 / 800

Sri Krishna Stores — Row title · 17 / 700

Pick one so your totals stay accurate — Body · 15 / 500

Today · 8:30 PM — Caption · 13 / 600

COMPONENTS

+ Add expense

Pay

Actions: marigold for the main action, ink for confirming.

Cash | UPI | Card

Chips for payment mode; tinted icon tiles carry each category.

Sri Krishna Stores −₹1,249
Suggested: Groceries 6:30 PM

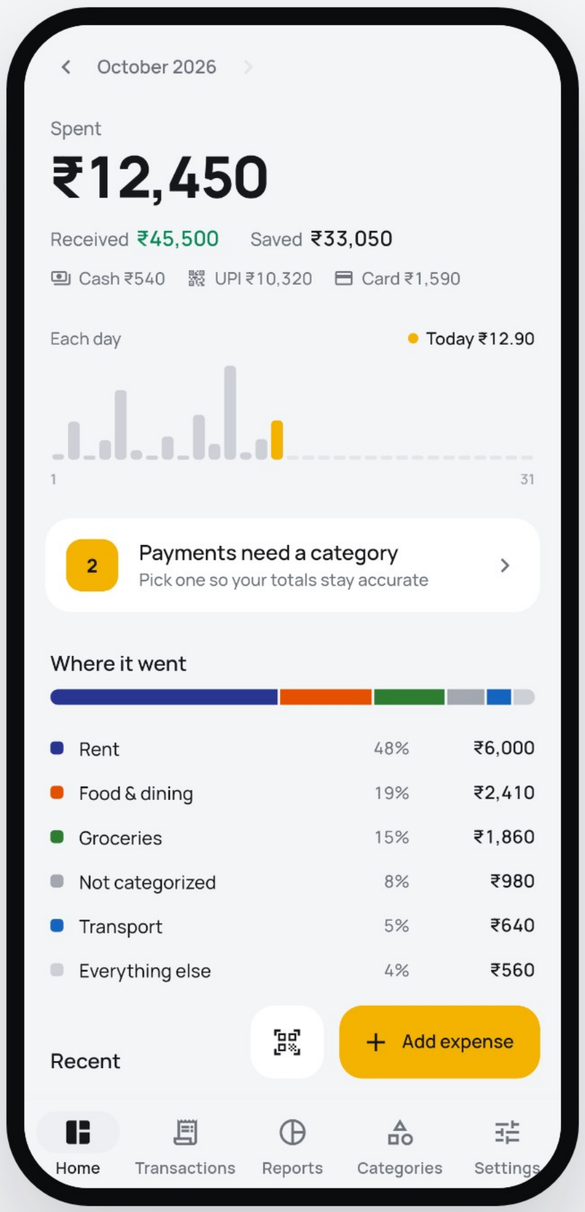
Acme Pvt Ltd +₹45,000
Salary 7:30 PM

Transaction row: state in the subtitle, sign and colour in the amount.

06

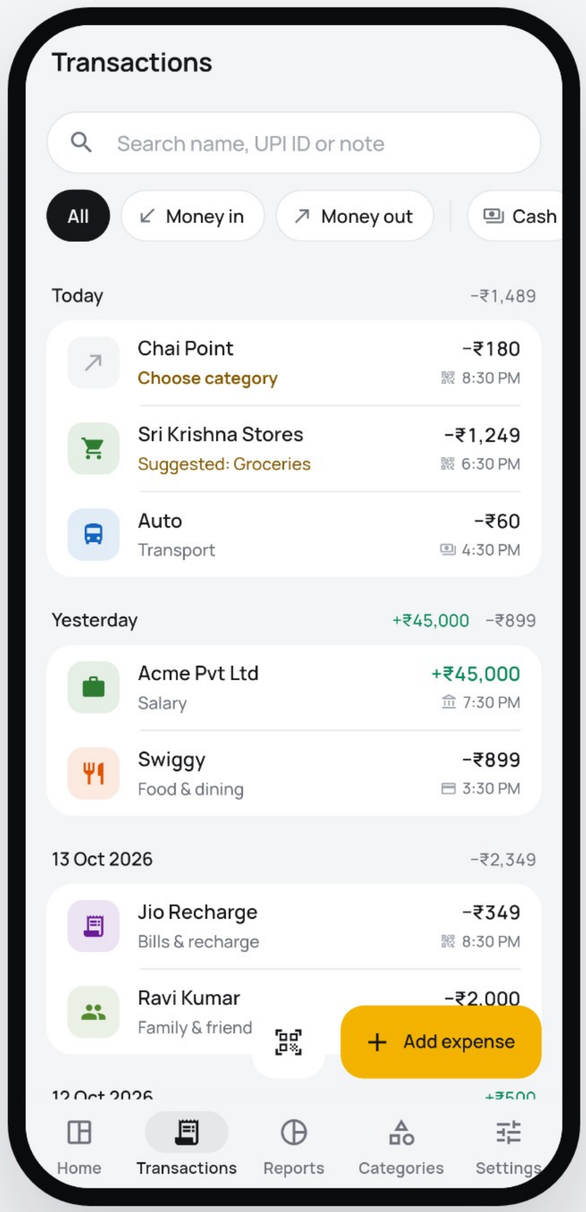
Capture without typing

Payments arrive on their own. The design's job is to make the one remaining decision, the category, quick and impossible to miss.



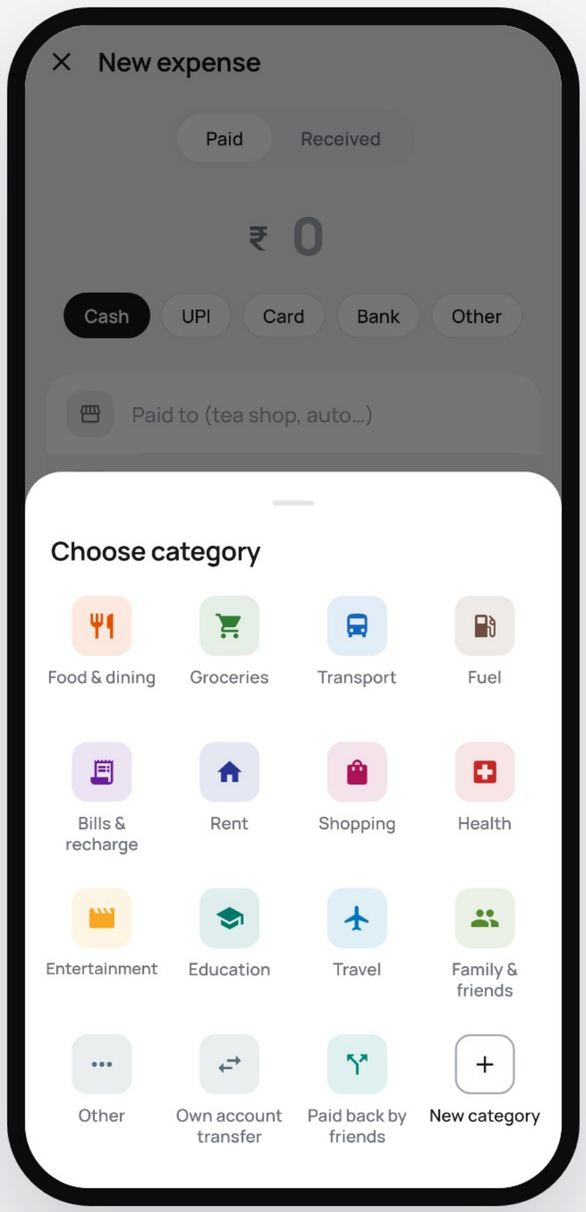
Home: the month at a glance

One big number for spent, then received and saved. A marigold card appears only when payments still need a category.



Transactions: state in every row

"Choose category" and "Suggested: Groceries" read differently at a glance. Search works on names, UPI IDs and amounts.



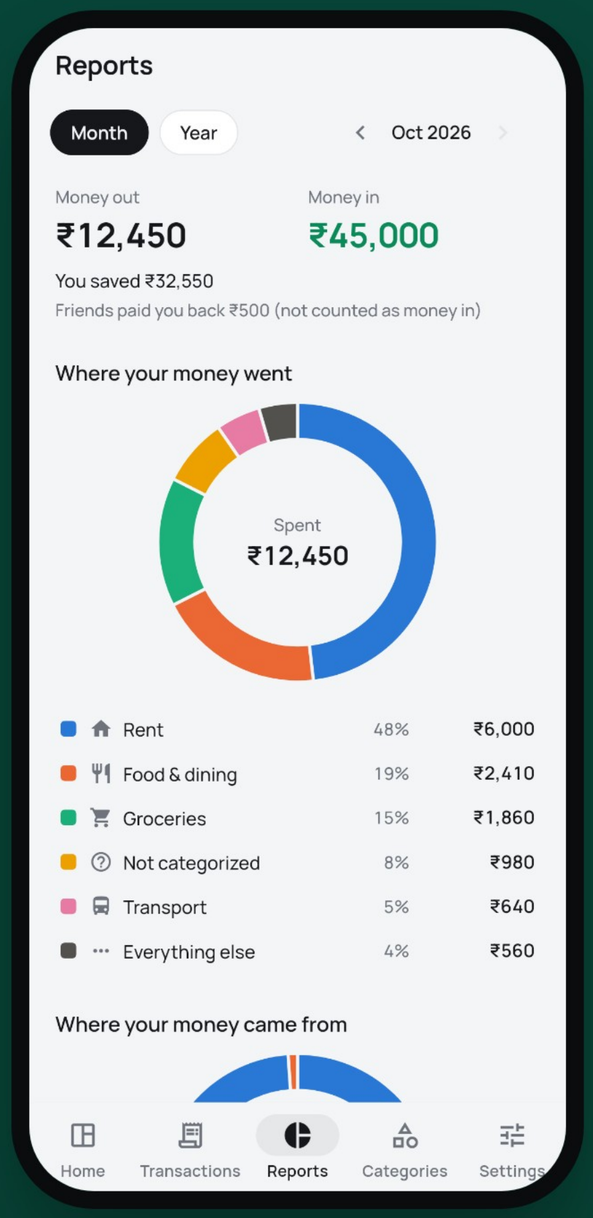
Picker: one tap, or a new one

A grid of big targets. Missing a category? "New category" asks only for a name; icon and colour can wait.

07

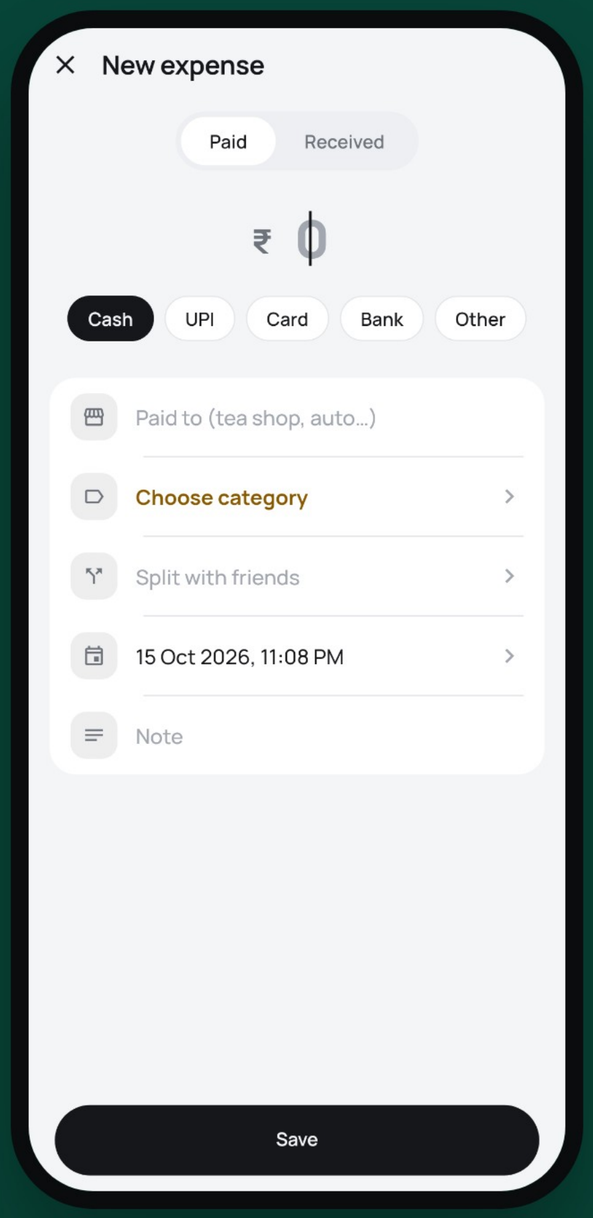
Understand and organise

Once payments have categories, the app can answer the real question: where did the money go? Everything here is adjustable, but nothing has to be set up first.



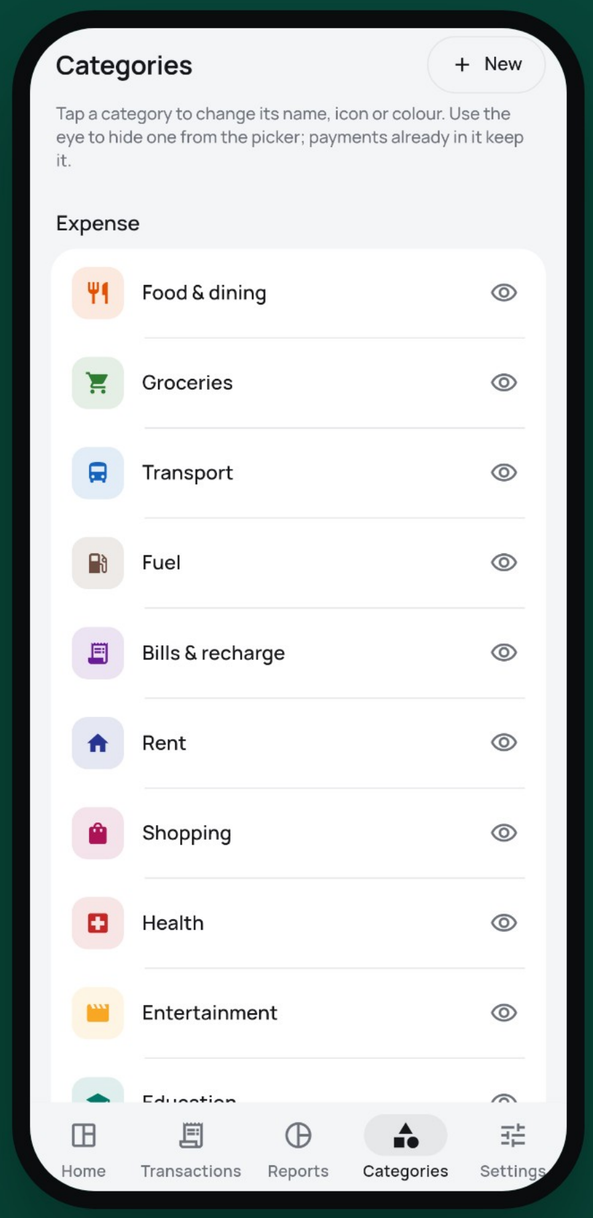
Reports: numbers first, then pies

Money out vs in is two big figures, not a two-slice pie. Separate donuts show where money went and where it came from; tap a slice for its amount.



Add by hand: amount first

For cash, the amount gets the focus and the keyboard. Split with friends records only your share, so a group dinner doesn't inflate spending.



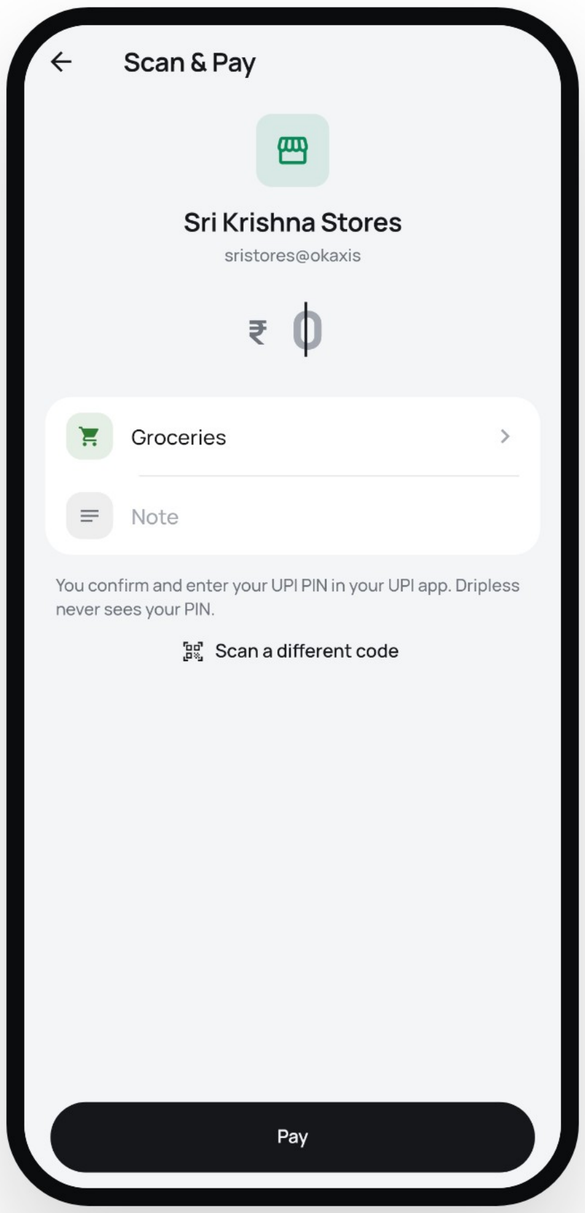
Categories: tidy up later

Tap to change name, icon or colour. The eye hides a category from the picker without touching past payments.

08

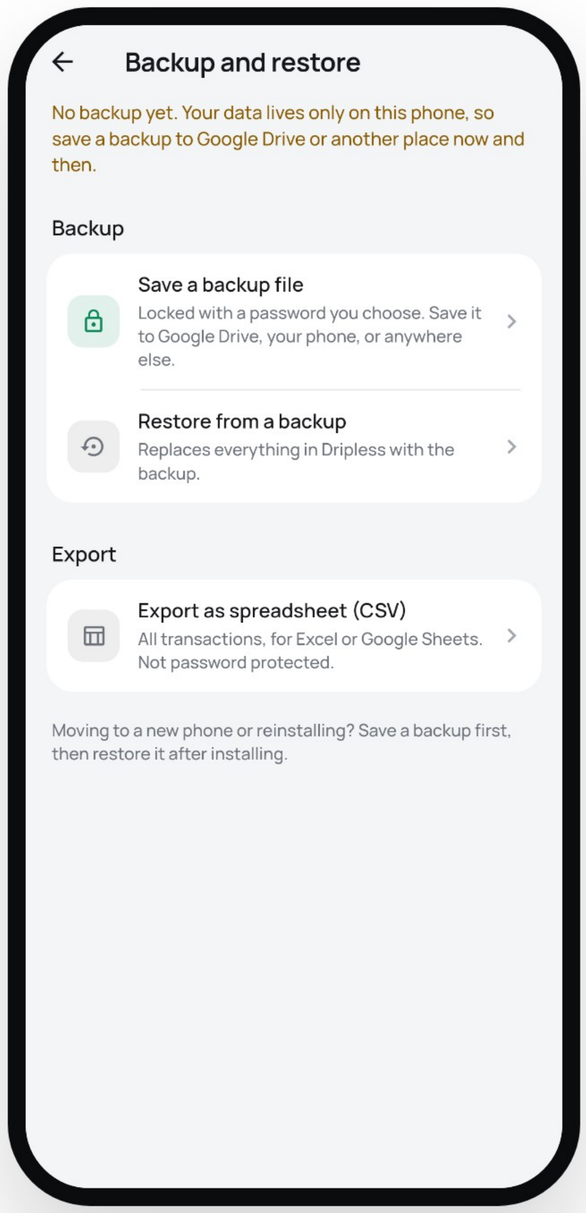
Pay, and stay in control

An app that reads bank messages has to earn trust in every screen. Privacy isn't a settings page here; it shapes what the app stores and what it says.



Scan & Pay: categorise before paying

The category is chosen while the context is fresh. The UPI PIN is always entered in GPay or PhonePe, and the screen says so.



Backup: your file, your password

No account and no server. A warning in plain words explains that data lives only on this phone until you save a backup.

PRIVACY PRINCIPLES

Nothing leaves the phone

Encrypted database, key in Android's secure storage. No cloud, no login.

Never keep an OTP

Messages with OTPs or PINs are skipped outright. Message text isn't stored, only the amount, payee and time.

Ask with a reason

SMS and notification access are explained at the moment they're needed, and the app works by hand without them.

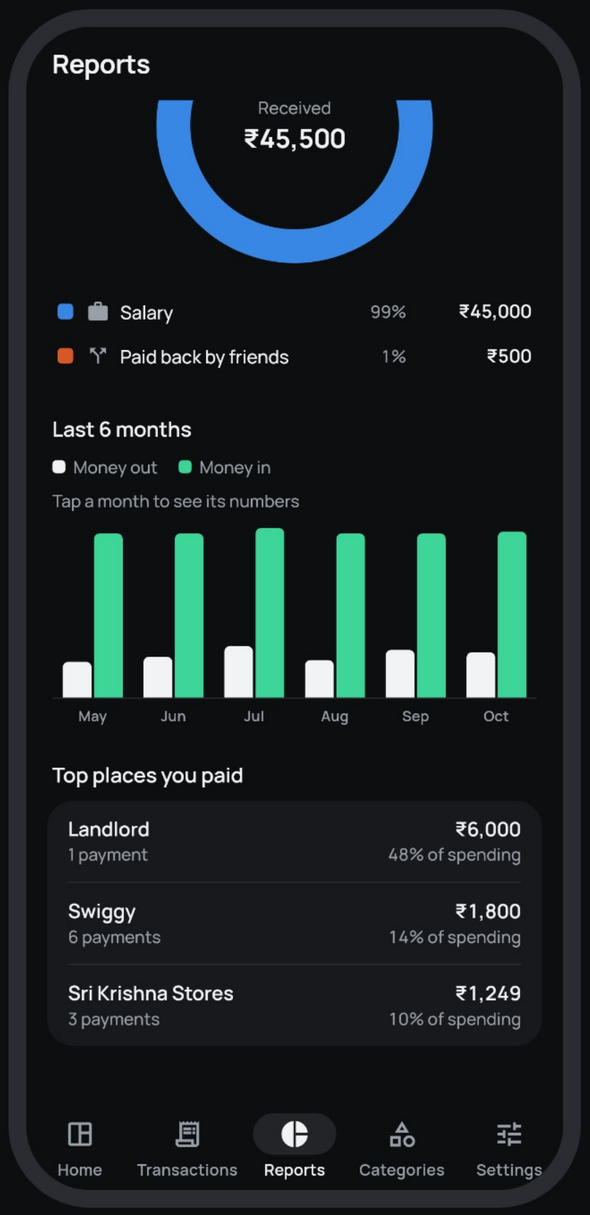
Show what was checked

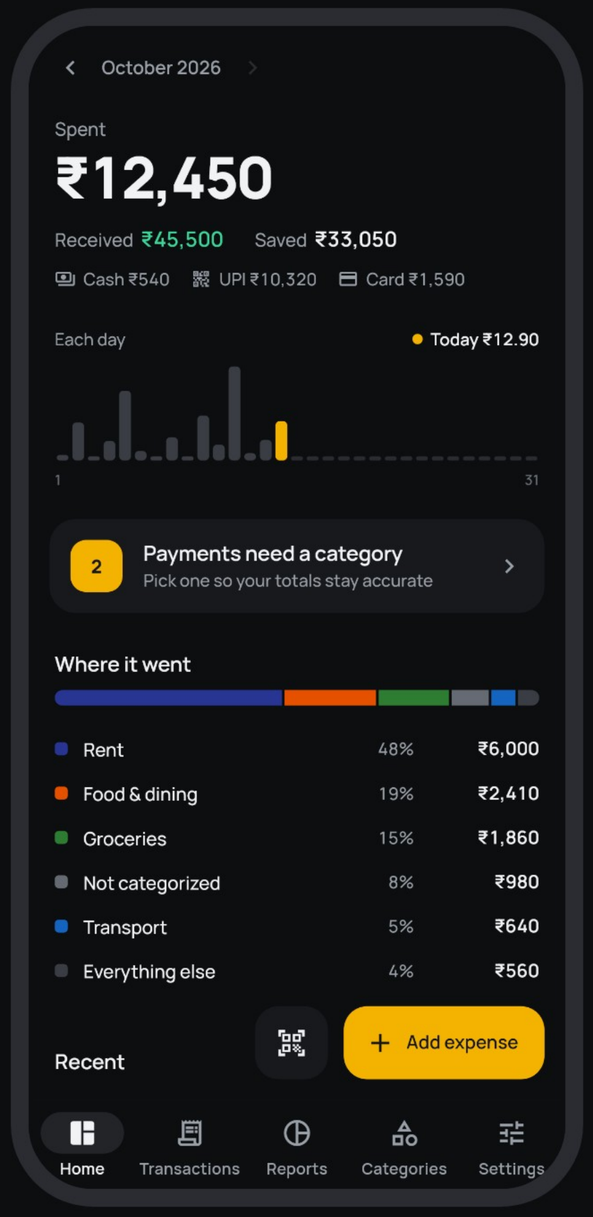
A short log in Settings lists recent messages and why each was saved or skipped.

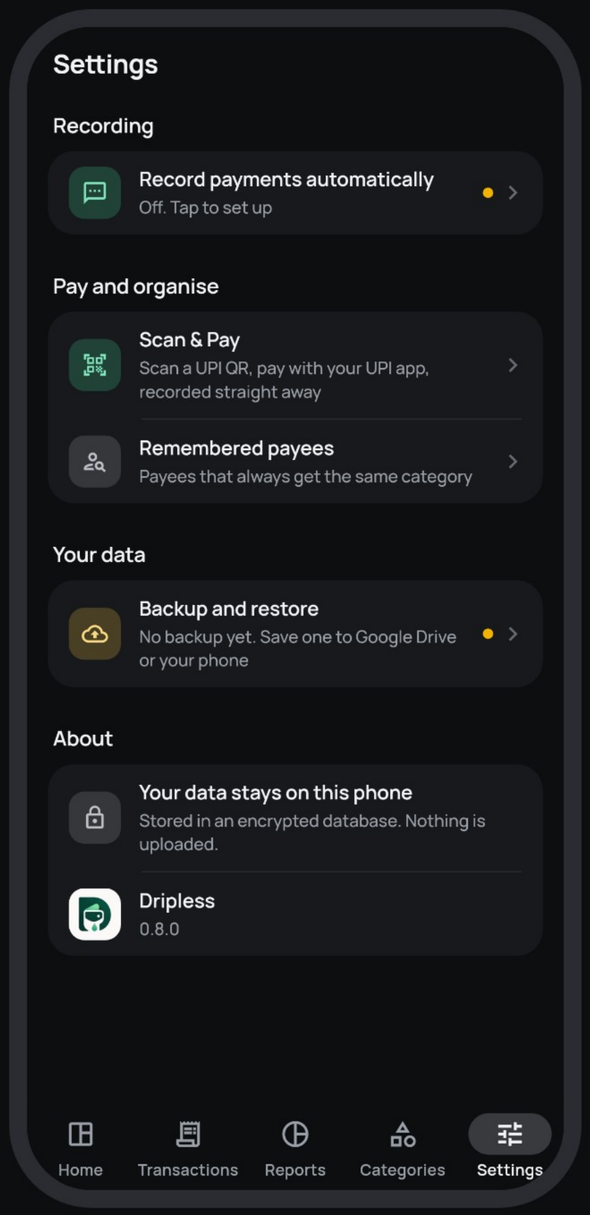
09

Dark mode

Not an inverted copy. Surfaces step up in lightness instead of using shadows, income green brightens to stay readable, and chart colours were re-checked for colour-blind contrast on dark.







10

Decisions and learnings

Ask at the moment of payment

A high-priority notification asks for the category while the payment is fresh, instead of a backlog to clear later.

Remember, then suggest

Once you file a payee, the next payment shows "Suggested" instead of asking from scratch.

Friends paying back isn't income

Settlements get their own category, so salary and "saved" stay honest.

Never rely on colour alone

Every chart slice also carries a name, icon and amount, and the palette is checked for colour-blind readers.

WHAT REAL PHONES TAUGHT ME

Bank SMS formats vary widely

Each bank phrases debits differently; testing with real messages shaped the detection rules.

A silent pop-up is a missing pop-up

The category prompt only worked once it was raised to a high-importance alert.

Empty states should stay quiet

Duplicate buttons in an empty list felt noisy, so actions now live in one place.

Thank you.

Thanks for scrolling through Dripless. I'd love to hear what you think, or talk about designing your next product.

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